

JIA, Mengzhao (she/her)

355 Fitzpatrick Hall, Notre Dame, IN 46556

jiamengzhao98@gmail.com

Education

Ph.D. in Computer Science and Engineering <i>University of Notre Dame, USA. Advisor: Prof. Meng Jiang</i>	08/2023 –
M.Phil. in Computer Science and Engineering <i>Shandong University, China. Advisor: Prof. Liqiang Nie</i>	09/2020 – 06/2023
B. Eng in Electronic Science and Technology <i>Shandong University, China.</i>	09/2016 – 06/2020

Work Experience

Research Intern at Orby AI, Mountain View, US. <i>Worked on Pub.[1]</i>	03/2025 – 09/2025
Research Intern at Tencent AI Lab, Seattle, US. <i>Worked on Pub.[2]</i>	05/2024 – 09/2024
Research Intern at Alibaba DAMO Academy, Hangzhou, China. <i>Worked on Pub.[6]</i>	06/2022 – 01/2023
Research Intern at Kuaishou Technology, Beijing, China. <i>Worked on Pub.[5]</i>	04/2021 – 01/2022

Research Interest: Multimodal Reasoning. Multimodal Large Language Models.

Google Scholar: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=E332upAAAAAJ>

Citations: 280; h-index: 9; i10-index: 9 (12/2025)

Recent Work

1. **Mengzhao Jia**, Zhihan Zhang, Ignacio Cases, Zheyuan Liu, Meng Jiang, Peng Qi. *AutoRubric: Rubric-Based Generative Rewards for Faithful Multimodal Reasoning*. **ACL 2026 Findings** [[Arxiv](#)] [[GitHub](#)] *TL;DR:* AutoRubric uses automatically generated rubrics in multimodal reinforcement learning to improve both accuracy and reasoning faithfulness.
2. **Mengzhao Jia**, Wenhao Yu, Kaixin Ma, Tianqing Fang, Zhihan Zhang, Siru Ouyang, Hongming Zhang, Meng Jiang, Dong Yu. *Leopard: A Vision Language Model for Text-Centric Multi-Image Tasks*. **TMLR**. [[Arxiv](#)] [[GitHub](#)] [[HuggingFace](#)] *TL;DR:* Leopard outperforms the best multimodal large language models by an average of +9.61 points on 5 text-rich, multi-image benchmarks. The constructed multi-image reasoning dataset got 200k+ downloads.
3. Zifeng Zhu*, **Mengzhao Jia***, Zhihan Zhang, Lang Li, Meng Jiang. *MultiChartQA: Benchmarking Vision-Language Models on Multi-Chart Problems*. **NAACL 2025**. [[Arxiv](#)] [[HuggingFace](#)] *TL;DR:* MultiChartQA evaluates how MLLMs perform multi-hop, comparative, and sequential reasoning across multiple charts.

4. **Mengzhao Jia**, Zhihan Zhang, Wenhao Yu, Fangkai Jiao, Meng Jiang. *Describe-then-Reason: Improving Multimodal Mathematical Reasoning through Visual Comprehension Training*. Under review. [[Arxiv](#)]

TL;DR: Decoupled visual comprehension and math reasoning training improves the performance of LLaVa-1.5-7B from 26.1 to 33.7 on MathVista and from 9.4 to 16.2 on MathVerse.

Peer-Reviewed Publications

5. **Jia**, Wei, Song, Sun, Zhang, Nie. *Query-oriented Micro-video Summarization*. IEEE **TPAMI**, 46 (6), 4174-4187, 2024.
6. **Jia**, Xie, Jing. *Debiasing Multimodal Sarcasm Detection with Contrastive Learning*. **AAAI** 2024.
7. **Jia**, Chen, Jing, Fu, Li. *Knowledge-enhanced Memory Model for Emotional Support Conversation*. Machine Learning for Cognitive and Mental Health Workshop, **AAAI** 2024.
8. Ouyang, Yu, Ma, Xiao, Zhang, **Jia**, Han, Yu. *Repograph: Enhancing ai software engineering with repository-level code graph*. **ICLR** 2025.
9. Liu, Dou, **Jia**, Tan, Zeng, Yuan, Jiang. *Protecting privacy in multimodal large language models with mllmu-bench*. **NAACL** 2025.
10. Zhang, Lee, Fang, Yu, **Jia**, Jiang, Barbieri. *PLUG: Leveraging Pivot Language in Cross-Lingual Instruction Tuning*. **ACL** 2024.
11. Jing, Song, Ouyang, **Jia**, Nie. *Multi-source Semantic Graph-based Multimodal Sarcasm Explanation Generation*. **ACL** 2023.
12. Nie, **Jia**, Song, Wu, Cheng, Gu. *Multimodal Activation: Awakening Dialog Robots without Wake Words*. **SIGIR** 2021.

Service

Reviewer for ACL, ICLR, CVPR, AAAI